

SOCIOLOGY & ANTHROPOLOGY

Notable Faculty & Student Achievements

March 2026

Several sociology faculty members and students attended the Eastern Sociological Society annual meeting in Washington, D.C. from March 5-8. Three sociology majors presented their capstone research: **Rylan Hastings** '26 presented "One Nation, Many Teams: Americans' Attitudes About Sport as a Unifier or Divider in Society," **Aris Morgan** '26 presented "The Perception of the West Under Threat: American Attitudes on China," and **Greta Nelson** '26 presented "They Don't Belong Here: Understanding American Opposition to Undocumented Immigration." Faculty and students also presented on their collaborative research projects: Assistant Professor of Sociology **Amanda Hernandez**, Morgan, and Nelson presented their 2025 SURF project "Stay Off Our TERF: Predictors of Anti-Trans Feminists Opposition to Trans Girls in K-12 Sports," and Professor of Sociology **Maria Lowe** and **Claire Adams** '27 presented "Suspicious Person Posts and Racial Profiling Anxiety in Neighborhoods." In addition, Hernandez presented work from ongoing research, "But Is It Feminist? The Highlights, Challenges, and Opportunities of Creating a Sociological and Transdisciplinary Podcast."

Assistant Professor of Anthropology **Naomi Reed** and Head of Distinctive Collections and Archives **Megan Firestone** were both interviewed and featured in the documentary "Segregation on Trial: Integrating Georgetown Schools," filmed and produced by City of Georgetown Communications Manager Keith Hutchinson. The film debuted and was screened at the Georgetown Public Library on February 26, where Naomi and Megan both sat on a panel to

February 2026

Professor of Anthropology **Melissa Johnson** presented "Revising the Early Social History of Belize, 1730-1820" at the Third International Caribbean Studies Forum at the University of Belize, Belmopan, on February 18. The talk can be viewed [here](#).

Professor of Sociology **Maria Lowe** has been awarded this year's Distinguished Contribution to Teaching Award by the Southern Sociological Society in recognition of outstanding achievements. Dr. Lowe will be honored during the Society's Presidential Honors and Convocation Plenary, held at their annual meeting in Jacksonville, FL in April.

December 2025

This article is based on a faculty-student collaborative research project and can be accessed [here](#).

November 2025

Professor of Anthropology **Melissa Johnson** organized a double panel for the American Anthropological Association in New Orleans on November 22, along with Dr. Patrick Gallagher of the University of Texas–San Antonio. The sessions were titled “Predatory Politics: The Wily Animal-Human Relationships of Hunting and Fishing” Part 1–Sea and Part 2–Land. Dr. Johnson presented “Tigah Camp: Unruly Multispecies assemblages, Race and Gender in a Belizean Trophy Jaguar Hunting Camp” in Part 2–Land.

Assistant Professor of Anthropology **Naomi Reed** presented her paper “A Healing African Diasporic Deconstruction of Ashkenormativity” at the American Anthropology Association Conference in New Orleans on November 20. The presentation was on the panel she also chaired, titled “Canonical Hauntings of the Body: On Harm and Healing—Knowledge Production and the Politics of Belonging.” Dr. Reed’s paper explores how the dismissal of whiteness by white presenting Ashkenazi Jewish Americans harms Jews of color and erases their experiences within the Jewish Diaspora. Through a critical inversion of the haunting paternalistic relationship between Jewish anthropologists and Blackness, she asks what Jewish Americans can learn from African Diaspora scholarship. She suggests that Jewish identity should be reconceptualized through African Diasporic notions of identity and race as a means to deconstruct Ashkenormativity and to fuel a healing critical recognition of Jewish diversity. Anthropology

ethnic identification among the French Kabyle. Particularly, they define how its corpus has codified and perpetuated hegemonic knowledge of belonging that supplant the diaspora's autonomy in self-conceptualization. They consider, then, how its communities negotiate what it means to be Kabyle through living encounters with discursive expression. Professor of Anthropology **Melissa Johnson** served as the discussant for this panel. The conference program can be found [here](#).

Assistant Professor of Sociology **Amanda Hernandez** presented a virtual book talk to women and gender studies students at California State University, Northridge on November 18. The focus of her talk was on feminist interview methodologies and the chapter "Wife – Mother – Girl Boss" from her 2024 book *Intersectional Identities of Christian Women in the United States: Faith, Race, and Feminism*.

Assistant Professor of Sociology **Adriana Ponce** was selected to participate in "Beyond Colonial Constraints: Cuir Feminist Praxis as Rupture and Healing across the Archipelago" at the NWSA annual conference in San Juan, Puerto Rico from November 12–16. The pre-conference opportunity was rooted in Boriken archipelago feminism to explore how gender and sexual minorities disrupt coloniality and embrace joy.

British coast of Central America, 1750-1830." Dr. Johnson and three students presented their papers: anthropology and feminist studies double major **Dina Gaxiola** '28 presented "The Case of Jane Trapp: Race, Gender, Slavery and Freedom in Early British Central America," psychology and sociology double major **Sophia Hernandez** '28 presented "From Enslavement to Influence; Gendered Agency, Racial Boundaries, and the Story of Ariadne Broaster," Dr. Johnson presented "Living across lines of freedom in the early history of Belize: The origins of the Bonner family," and biology and environmental studies double major **Shae Whitney** '28 presented "Maria Middleton – Slave, Criminal, Transported Convict: Understanding Gender, Race and Freedom across the British Colonial World." The students may have been the only undergraduates presenting papers at this conference. The papers were well received, with one audience member sharing that this was the most interesting panel they had attended.

Assistant Professor of Sociology **Adriana Ponce** published her critical literature review on U.S. stepfamilies in the *Journal of Sociology Compass*. The article, "A Literature Review of U.S. Stepfamilies: Directions Toward an Intersectional, Feminist Understanding of Lived Experiences Centered on Social Justice Praxis," is part of a special issue centering on intersectionality, titled "Beyond Boundaries: Reviewing the Multifaceted Dimensions of Intersectionality," and identifies a glaring gap and directions for new knowledge creation centered on community engagement. The article can be read [here](#).

Assistant Professor of Sociology **Amanda Hernandez** served as an invited panelist on an "Author Meets Critics" panel at the Sociology for the Scientific Study of Religion annual meeting in Minneapolis on October 31. The book, "Faith & The Fragility of Justice: Responses to Gender-Based Violence in South Africa," by Meredith Whitnah is an exploration of non-governmental organization responses to gender-based violence in post-apartheid South Africa. Amanda's

Professor of Anthropology **Melissa Johnson** participated in the Kulcha 2025 symposium, hosted by the Heritage Education Network Belize, from October 29–31. She presented “Early Belizean Social History: The case of the Crawford family” on October 29. The presentation can be accessed here at 4:54 (4 hours, 54 minutes); the live Q and A starts about 30 minutes later.

October 2025

Professor of Anthropology **Melissa Johnson** led a workshop on the “Early Social History of the Lower Belize River Valley” for undergraduate students at the University of Belize (UB) from October 17–18. Eight students and two professors from UB spent Friday working with archival documents and information that Dr. Johnson has collected to start to tell the story of a family of color who lived in British Central America starting in the mid 1700s. The president of the university and two deans joined the workshop for Dr. Johnson’s presentation. The following day, Dr. Johnson organized a field trip for the group to Belizean Creole villages in the lower Belize River Valley, where the group learned about history and culture first hand from elders of the communities. Dr. Johnson worked closely with Lecturer in History and Coordinator of the Intercultural Indigenous Language Institute Delmer Tzib and Assistant Professor of English Christopher De Shield to develop the workshop. The activities were all sponsored by funding from the Mellon Foundation’s Grant to SU, “Deepening the Heart of Texas: Public-Engaged Humanities for Social Justice.”

Assistant Professor of Anthropology **Naomi Reed** presented a talk, titled “Oral History as Liberation,” at the Universities Studying Slavery Consortium’s Fall Conference, “Second Foundings: Universities, Slavery, and Struggles for Justice in Texas and Beyond,” at Rice University in Houston on Saturday, October 11. She discussed the Southwestern University Racial History Project’s oral history collection and the critical methodology used to gather, preserve, and exhibit stories of alumni of color. Her talk featured an excerpt of the oral history of **Eva Mendiola** ’75 that was recorded by SCOPE 2022 student **Kalista Esquivel** ’26 as well as a clip of the forthcoming documentary that she created with Esquivel and SURF 2025 student **Mia Santoscoy** ’26 about Mendiola’s journey to founding women’s sports at SU. The conference program can be found [here](#).

August 2025

Sociology and feminist studies graduate **Emily Dimiceli** ’25 received an honorable mention for the prestigious Joe Feagin Undergraduate Paper Award for her fall 2025 sociology capstone project. This national award, presented by the Sociology of Racial and Ethnic Minorities section of the American Sociological Association (ASA), recognizes outstanding undergraduate scholarship. Emily accepted the honor at this year’s ASA meeting in Chicago. In its commendation, the award committee described Emily’s paper as “ambitious original research... well-grounded in racial theory, including conceptualizations of colorblind racism and historical racism.”

ChristianGirl: The White Commodified Self on TikTok.” Amanda’s 2024 book, *Intersectional Identities of Christian Women in the U.S.: Faith, Race, and Feminism*, was the subject of an “Author Meets Critic” book panel.

July 2025

Assistant Professor of Sociology **Amanda Hernandez** was interviewed on the “Classical Ideas” podcast about her 2024 book *Intersectional Identities of Christian Women in the United States: Faith, Race, and Feminism*. The episode can be streamed [here](#). She also soft launched her forthcoming podcast “But Is It Feminist?,” which can be heard [here](#).

May 2025

Sociology and feminist studies double major and race and ethnicity studies minor **Emily Dimiceli** '25 has been accepted into the 2025 American Sociological Association’s (ASA) Honors Program. As a part of the program, she will present her capstone research paper, titled “‘Obama was voted president by white people’: Predictors of Americans’ Perceptions of Racism,” at this year’s ASA annual meeting in Chicago, IL.

April 2025

Sociology students and faculty members attended the Southern Sociological Society annual meeting in Charlotte, NC from April 9-12. Five sociology seniors presented their capstone research: **Catherine Angell** presented "Presidency or Penitentiary: Exploring Americans' Attitudes Towards Felons' Right to Vote;" **Isabella Bahamon** presented "Life, Liberty, and the Pursuit of Choice: Predicting Americans' Attitudes Towards Abortion Rights," which won the 2025 Odum Award for Best Undergraduate Paper; **Emily Dimiceli** presented "'Obama was voted president by white people': Predictors of Americans' Perceptions of Racism;" **Mary Kate McAdams** presented "'It seems like the system has a few favorites': Factors that Affect American Attitudes about Racial and Economic Bias in the Criminal Justice System;" and **Chelsey Rocha** presented "'DEI is just racism against white people': Americans Attitudes About Anti-DEI Bills in Higher Education." In addition, faculty and students presented on their collaborative research projects. Assistant Professor of Sociology **Amanda Hernandez** and environmental studies major **Sarah Ventimiglia** '25 presented their co-authored study titled, "Hashtag Blessed: Performances of White Femininity and Consumption on TikTok." Professor of Sociology **Maria Lowe** presented her collaborative study (with co-authors Dr. Reginald Byron of the University of Denver, **Brigit Reese** '24, and **Carson Maxfield** '24) titled, "Residents of Color in non-Predominantly White Neighborhoods: Are They More Likely to Worry about Racialized Surveillance Than White Residents?"

Assistant Professor of Sociology **Adriana Ponce** and sociology major **Chelsey Rocha** '25 presented "Intersectionality, Accessibility, and Fraudulent Behavior: Feminist, Qualitative Methodology and Emerging Virtual Recruitment" at the Southern Sociological Society (SSS) Annual Conference in Charlotte, NC. Dr. Ponce and Chelsey's presentation wrestled with accessible recruitment practices for diverse stepfamilies while protecting the data from interested respondents misrepresenting their qualifications for the study.

Assistant Professor of Anthropology **Naomi Reed** organized and supported the submission, reception, and presentation of the panel "Salons, Skateboarding, and Tabletop Gaming: Stories of 'Alternative' Intersectional Gender Expression in Recreational Communities," presented on April 4 at the 2025 Southwestern Anthropology Association Conference in Pomona, CA. During this panel, anthropology and classics double major **Marley Sensenderfer** '25 chaired the session and presented the paper talk "Roll for Stereotypes: D&D and Gender Performativity Tabletop role-playing games," anthropology major **Emma French** '25 presented the paper talk "Gender and Skateboarding Culture," and anthropology and environmental studies double major **Rose Reed** '25 presented the paper talk "White Beauty Standards in a Hair and Nail Salon." This panel was a collaboration of three student anthropology capstone research projects that deconstruct intersectional manifestations of gender in public space via insider (or native) ethnographic analysis. More information on the session and the conference can be found [here](#).

Professor of Anthropology **Melissa Johnson**'s article "Tigah camp: unruly multispecies assemblages, race and gender in a Belizean trophy jaguar hunting camp" has just been published in the journal *Latin American and Caribbean Ethnic Studies*. It can be read [here](#).

Professor of Sociology **Maria Lowe**, sociology and business graduate **ThuyMi Phung** '23, and sociology and art history graduate **Katherine Holcomb** '23 presented their co-authored paper titled "The Interaction of Race and Racial Grievance: Predictors of American Attitudes about Critical Race Theory" at the Eastern Sociological Society annual meeting in Boston from March 6-9.

Assistant Professor of Sociology **Amanda Hernandez** was selected to be in the Sacred Writes Spring 2025 Carpenter Cohort. Sacred Writes provides support, resources, and networks for scholars of religion committed to translating the significance of their research to a broader audience. This spring cohort focuses on training scholars of religion, gender, and sexuality on translating their work into public scholarship. More about the program and her cohort can be found [here](#).

Isabella Bahamon '25 was selected for the Southern Sociological Society's 2025 Howard Odum Award for Best Undergraduate Paper for her capstone project titled, "Life, Liberty, and the Pursuit of Choice: American Attitudes about Abortion Rights in the United States." Professor of Sociology **Maria Lowe** supervised Isabella's project during this year's sociology capstone class.

February 2025

Assistant Professors of Sociology **Adriana Ponce** and **Amanda Hernandez**, Assistant Professor of Political Science **Alexander Goodwin**, Assistant Professor of History **Bryan Kauma**, and Assistant Professor of English **Sonia Del Hierro** published "Teaching with Color: Thematic Hires and the Politics of Teaching in Texas," in the journal *Sociology of Race and Ethnicity*. This article joins a growing conversation in the humanities and humanistic social sciences on ways faculty of color shoulder the burden of thinking about our shared futures as racialized, intersectional, and collaborative. You can find the article [here](#).

January 2025

Sociology and business alumna **ThuyMi Phung** '23 has published an article with Professor of Sociology **Maria Lowe** titled "The Armed Home and Support for Trump: Predictors of Americans' Attitudes Toward Gun Violence" in the *Journal of Integrated Social Sciences*. This work represents ThuyMi's first peer-reviewed publication and stems from her Fall 2022 capstone project. The article can be found [here](#). ThuyMi continues her research on attitudes about gun violence at the University of Washington where she is completing her Master's in Public Health.

Assistant Professor of Anthropology **Naomi Reed** organized a panel titled “Blackness and Whiteness in the Americas: Race Across Space and Time” for the American Anthropological Association’s 2024 annual meeting in Tampa, FL on November 21. Professor of Anthropology **Melissa Johnson** served as the chair for the panel. During this session, Dr. Reed presented the paper “Black Surrogacy and the Sugar Land 95: How White Officials in Sugar Land, Texas use Black Subjectivity to Fabricate a Social Justice Image,” Dr. Johnson presented the paper “Emerging Racial Categories and their Socio-ecological Context on the British Coast of Central America in the Late 1700s,” and undergraduate honors anthropology student **Constanza Cameron** ’24 presented the paper “Chilean Whiteness: Affective Dispositions Regarding Race and Class.” Alumnus **Zacharia Arifi** ’24 presented the poster presentation “1760 Hors Place: Discursive Identity Formation of the Franco-Kabyle Diaspora and the PostKabyle” as well. Abstracts of the panel, the papers, and the poster can be found [here](#).

November 2024

Assistant Professor of Sociology **Adriana Ponce** and sociology major **Chelsey Rocha** ’25 presented “Stepparents in America: Unearthing Distinct Practices and Processes” at the National Women’s Studies Association (NWSA) annual conference in Detroit, MI. Dr. Ponce and Chelsey’s presentation highlighted their community engaged project’s current progress and developments.

Assistant Professor of Sociology **Amanda Hernandez** presented preliminary insights from her project, "Teaching Christianity and Whiteness in Turbulent Times," at the Society for the Scientific Study of Religion (SSSR) conference in Pittsburgh from October 17–20.

Professor of Anthropology **Melissa Johnson** was an invited participant in the Third Coast Central America Collaborative at Texas Christian University from October 17-18, where she presented "The Flowers' Story: Emerging Racial Categories and their Socio-ecological context on the British Coast of Central America in the late 1700s."

Assistant Professor of Sociology **Amanda Hernandez** published her first monograph, "Intersectional Identities of Christian Women in the United States: Faith, Race, and Feminism" (2024, Lexington Books). Based in content analysis, interviews, and survey data, Hernandez problematizes the view that Christianity and feminism are contradictory identities. More information is available [here](#).

Assistant Professor of Sociology **Amanda Hernandez** served as an invited panelist for “Where There Is Oppression: Doing Sociology in Challenging Times and Places,” at the American Sociological Association Annual Meeting in Montreal.

Assistant Professor of Sociology **Amanda Hernandez**, Assistant Professor of Sociology **Adriana Ponce**, Assistant Professor of Political Science **Alexander Goodwin**, Assistant Professor of History **Bryan Kauma**, and Assistant Professor of English **Sonia Del Hierro** had their abstract “Teaching With Color: Thematic Hires and the Politics of Teaching in Texas” accepted as a special feature for the 10 Year Reflection Special Issue on pedagogy and hope in the *Journal for the Sociology of Race & Ethnicity*. The article will be both a pedagogical reflection on hope in the classroom and on thematic hires. The issue will be available in early 2025.

July 2024

Professor of Anthropology **Melissa Johnson** presented “Lucy’s Story: The Surprising Tale of an Enslaved Black Woman in British Central America in the 1770s” as the inaugural webinar for the Government of Belize’s Institute of Social and Cultural Research-National Institute of Culture and History Research Lab Series 2.0 on July 24. It was well attended and is posted on the ISCR-NICH YouTube channel, available [here](#).

Assistant Professor of Sociology **Amanda Hernandez** published a feature article in the Summer edition of the magazine *Conscience*, titled "Are There Christian Feminists? How White Supremacy Impacts Our Assumptions About Identity." In the article, Hernandez highlights the role that white supremacy plays in the common assumption that feminism and faith are at odds.

May 2024

Professor of Anthropology **Melissa Johnson** has just published "Lucy's Story: The Surprising Tale of an Enslaved Black Woman in British Central America in the 1770s" in *Anthropology Now*. The article can be read [here](#).

April 2024

Assistant Professor of Anthropology **Naomi Reed** (panel organizer) and Professor of Anthropology **Melissa Johnson** (panel chair), along with two SCOPE undergraduate students, **Rose Reed** '25 and **Kalista Esquivel** '26, presented their panel "Unsilencing the Past: How Oral Histories Give Voice to Black and Latinx Students at Southwestern University" on April 18 at the Southwestern Social Science Association Conference in New Orleans, LA. Dr. Johnson discussed the foundational history of the University and the founding of The SU Racial History

University between 1980-1984, played basketball for the university, and was very active on campus. Kalista presented the oral history of Eva Mendiola, a Mexican-American woman who attended Southwestern University from 1972-1975 and founded the volleyball team, which was the first women's sports team on campus. Future plans include submitting these student papers to a special issue of an oral history journal. The conference program can be viewed [here](#).

Sociology major **Elena Clark** '24 was selected as the first place winner in the prestigious Alpha Kappa Delta national undergraduate paper competition for her capstone project titled "'Freedom of the streets' or 'Barriers to success?' Factors that Predict Attitudes About Homelessness In The United States." Elena competed against sociology majors from R1s, liberal arts universities, and other schools across the country. Her award comes with a cash prize and travel money to the August 2024 American Sociological Association (ASA) meeting in Montreal, Quebec, where she will participate in the ASA Honors Program, present her paper, and receive her award at the AKD Awards Ceremony. Professor of Sociology **Maria Lowe** served as Elena's faculty mentor for this project.

Professor of Sociology **Maria Lowe** and four sociology seniors attended the Southern Sociological Society annual meeting in New Orleans, LA from April 3-6. Each student also presented their capstone research. **Elena Clark** '24 presented her paper titled, "'Freedom of the streets' or 'Barriers to success?' Factors that Predict Attitudes About Homelessness In The United States." **Liana Collins** '24 presented her paper titled, "Americans' Attitudes About Second Language Learning in the U.S." **Carson Maxfield** '24 presented his paper titled, "Who is More Likely to Support Conspiracy Theories? Examining the Connections between Education, Gender, and Beliefs in Conspiracy Theory." **Brigit Reese** '24 presented her paper titled, "Hope, Nope, or Cope: Americans' Perceptions about Climate Change in the 2020s." In addition, Lowe, Reese, and

Professor of Anthropology **Melissa Johnson** presented the paper "The Crawford Family Line: Subaltern Socio-Ecological Formations on the British Coast of Central America in the 1700s" at the Political Ecology Society/Society for Applied Anthropology 84th Annual Meeting on March 27 in Santa Fe, NM.

Assistant Professor of Anthropology **Naomi Reed** and investigative journalist Brittney Martin received a 2024 Gracie Award for Best Investigative Feature [Radio - Nationally Syndicated Non-Commercial] for their podcast series "Sugar Land." The Gracie Awards celebrate women in media. More info can be found [here](#).

February 2024

Assistant Professor of Anthropology **Naomi Reed** was invited to present at the Yale Center for the Study of Race, Indigeneity, and Transnational Migration Historical Studies of Texas Symposium on February 9th and 10th in Austin, Texas. On the roundtable "Community-Based Scholarship," she

discovered and how the broader Black descendant community of the 95 has been ignored, thus resulting in subpar memorialization efforts by the local school district that owns the land the bodies are buried on.

Professor of Anthropology **Melissa Johnson's** work on Belize was featured in the January 19, 202, JSTOR Daily.

Assistant Professor of Sociology **Adriana Ponce** participated in the Sociologist for Women in Society (SWS) 2024 winter meeting in Santa Ana Pueblo, New Mexico, from January 25 to 28. She presented her project, "The Intersectional Landscape of Stepparents in the U.S.: What's Next?," which advocates for an intersectional, feminist approach to stepparenting research, in preparation for a Faculty-Student Project (FSP).

explored the impact of white redemptive narratives—in media, archaeology reports, history curriculum, and cemetery signage—of Black history on the memorialization efforts of the Sugar Land 95 in Fort Bend County, TX.

Assistant Professor of Sociology **Amanda Hernandez** presented “‘My Last Evangelical Hold Out’: Pro-Life, Pro-Choice, and Everything in Between” at the American Academy of Religion Conference in San Antonio, TX.

November 2023

Professor of Anthropology **Melissa Johnson** was part of a collaborative team of nearly 50 social scientists whose publication “Governance and Conservation Effectiveness in Protected Areas and Indigenous and Locally Managed Areas” *Annual Review of Environment and Resources* 48: 559-588 has just come out. It is available [here](#).

This past weekend (Oct 19-22), Assistant Professor of Sociology **Amanda Hernandez** attended the Society for the Scientific Study of Religion and convened a session entitled "Feminist Approaches to the Sociology of Religion." Additionally, she presented her paper "The Sacred & The Secular: Examining the Intersection of Feminist Christian Identification and Progressive Social Issues" with collaborator Tess Starman of Howard University and served as a guest panelist for "Religion And...How to Bring the Study of Religion into Conversation Across Disciplines."

Professor of Anthropology **Melissa Johnson** was an invited speaker for the 26th Meeting of the United Kingdom-Belize Association (UKBA) at University College London on October 13, 2023. She presented a revised and longer version of her paper "Lucy's Story: A Window into the Shore and the Bay in the late 1700s" via Zoom, and it was very well received.

Assistant Professor of Anthropology **Naomi Reed** was invited to discuss her podcast "Sugar Land" on the panel "Can you hear us now? Storytelling in podcasting" at the 2023 Mayborn Literary Nonfiction Conference hosted by The University of North Texas in Dallas, Texas, this past weekend October 13-14th. (<https://www.themayborn.com/schedule>). Dr. Reed and her co-host, investigative journalist Brittney Martin discussed their process of writing and editing "Sugar Land" and the benefit of interdisciplinary collaboration in storytelling and producing public scholarship.

September 2023

Professor of Sociology **Maria Lowe**, Luis Romero (2018-19 SU Mellon Teaching Fellow), and Madeline Carrola '19 published an article titled "'Racism Masked as Safety Concerns': The Experiences of Residents of Color With Racialized Coveillance in a Predominantly White Neighborhood" in the journal Sociology of Race and Ethnicity. In their article, the authors coin the term racialized coveillance and discuss ways that residents of color navigate and are negatively impacted by such resident-initiated monitoring practices.

April 2023

Professor of Sociology **Maria Lowe** and two sociology students attended the Southern Sociological Society annual meeting in Myrtle Beach, SC. In addition, Angel Ferrales '25 presented her capstone paper titled, "'As long as everything is legal and consensual, there's no problem': Attitudes that help to predict efforts to ban online subscription sexual content websites," ThuyMi Phung '24 presented her capstone paper, "'There are Always Going to be the Bad People who Access the Guns': Predictors of Americans' Perspectives on Gun Violence," and Maria Lowe and ThuyMi Phung presented their faculty-student collaborative research project titled, "'Because history has been whitewashed for decades:' Predictors of Attitudes about Critical Race Theory" Katherine Holcomb '24 was a co-author on this project.

ThuyMi Phung '23 received the Southern Sociological Society's 2023 Howard Odum Award for Best Undergraduate Paper for her capstone paper titled, "'There are always going to be bad people who access guns': Predictors of Americans' Perspectives on Gun Violence." **Maria Lowe** Professor of Sociology and Morenz Endowed Professor, supervised ThuyMi's project during this year's sociology capstone class.

November 2022

Professor of Anthropology **Melissa Johnson** presented "Feeling Climate Change in the Unruly Environment of Central Belize" for the roundtable "How Does Climate Change Feel? (Re)Thinking Cultural Embodied Responses To Environmental Precarity" at the 2022 annual meeting of the American Anthropological Association, held November 9-13 in Seattle, Washington.

October 2022

Professor of Anthropology **Melissa Johnson** traveled with three students who worked with and were mentored by Assistant Professor of Anthropology **Naomi Reed** this summer through SCOPE to represent Southwestern at the Universities Studying Slavery Fall 2022 Conference, held

with Reed titled "An Overview of the Southwestern University Racial History Project"; **Maria (Cony) Cameron** '24 presented "Exploring Policy and Racial Climate"; **Aspen Coriz-Romero** '24 presented "Building Communities of Care and Organizing Resistance at Southwestern University"; and **Kellie Henderson** '23 presented "Early Life of Black Students and Faculty on Southwestern University Campus." The panel was well attended, and attendees (primarily faculty) were very impressed with the students.

April 2022

Professor of Sociology **Sandi Nenga** presented her paper "When Six Feet Feels Like Six Miles: Children's Images of Their Lives During the Pandemic" at the Southern Sociological Society 85th Annual Meeting, held April 6–9 in Birmingham, Alabama. **Hannah Mitchell** '22 also presented her capstone paper "Praise on the Stage and Criticism in Class: Understanding Relationships Between Students and Their Instructors in Competitive Irish Dance Studios."

March 2022

Professor of Sociology **Sandi Nenga** published a chapter titled "When Six Feet Feels Like Six Miles: Children's Images of Their Lives during the COVID-19 Pandemic" in the book *COVID-19 and Childhood Inequality* edited by Nazneen Kane (Routledge). Students in Nenga's fall 2020

Feburary 2022

Professor of Anthropology **Melissa Johnson**'s review of Rajeshwari Dutt's book *Empire on Edge: The British Struggle for Order in Belize during Yucatán's Caste War, 1847–1901* was recently published in *The American Historical Review*.

Professor of Anthropology **Melissa Johnson** was invited to join the editorial board of *PoLAR: Political and Legal Anthropology Review*, the leading journal for political and legal anthropology. She will serve a three-year term.

December 2021

Predominantly White Neighborhood” in the journal *Social Currents*. In the article, they identify digital and in-person racialized surveillance as a key mechanism that enforces racialized boundaries in publicly accessible neighborhood spaces and highlight how Black and Latinx residents in particular navigate these practices.

November 2021

Professor of Anthropology **Melissa Johnson** organized and participated in a roundtable session cosponsored by the Society for Cultural Anthropology and the American Ethnology Society titled “Embodying Praxis: Everyday Work Toward a Liberatory Anthropology” at the 2021 American Anthropological Association Annual Meeting in Baltimore, Maryland, on November 20. One of the other roundtable participants was Cristina Alcalde, formerly of Southwestern, who now is vice president for institutional diversity and inclusion and professor of global and intercultural studies at Miami University in Ohio.

Assistant Professor of Anthropology **Naomi Reed** recently participated in *WAIL*, a community grief ritual performance commemorating the Sugar Land 95. She also presented on an invited panel discussion hosted by Diverse Works and the African American Library at the Gregory School titled “Unshackling History: Convict Leasing Camps in Sugar Land, TX.” Reed presented her research on the white redemptive ways in which the local school district, city, and county are responding to the discovery of the Sugar Land 95.

October 2021

Southwestern University was well represented at the 11th Race, Ethnicity, and Place Conference, held October 20–23 in Baltimore, Maryland. The SU Racial History Project presented a panel featuring research from both 2020 and 2021 SCOPE projects. The panel included:

- Professor of Anthropology **Melissa Johnson**: “The Southwestern Racial History Project: An Overview”
- **Kristine Velez** ’22 (Anthropology): “McKenzie College: A Plantation on the Edge of Indigenous Territory”
- **Saul Zuniga** ’22 (History): “Soule University, Slavery, and the Confederacy”
- **Juan Mojica** ’22 (Anthropology): “Hispanics, Methodism, and the Reproduction of Whiteness”
- **Rini Mannankara** ’22 (Political Science and Anthropology): “The Presence and Representation of Blackness in the 1960s and 1970s at Southwestern University”

In addition, SU alumna **Esther S. Ramos-Garcia** ’19 (Latin American and Border Studies), who is currently a graduate student at the University of Texas in the Teresa Lozano Long Institute of Latin American Studies program, presented “Accompanando Ninos Migrantes ‘No Acompañados’: A Feminist Geopolitical Perspective on Central American Unaccompanied Minors in U.S. Long-Term Foster Care (LTFC)” as part of a panel titled “Asylum in Crisis.”

(2022).

September 2021

Assistant Professor Sociology **Erika Grajeda** published an article titled "Worker Centres and Coming Out Politics in Migrant Struggles" in the journal *Citizenship Studies*.

Assistant Professor of Anthropology **Naomi Reed** was invited to present her research findings on the Sugar Land 95 at the virtual Sugar Land and African American History: Convict Leasing and its Legacies in Current Scholarship, Education, and Activism Conference held September 10–11. Reed presented on the relationship between white racial identity formation in Fort Bend County and the ways in which the city and local school district have made invisible the historical injuries suffered by the 94 Black men and one woman who worked the sugar plantations that provided the economic foundation of what is today Sugar Land, Texas.

Katherine Holcomb '23 participated in the American Sociological Association's 2021 Undergraduate Honors Program (held online) on August 7. She presented the paper "Fear of Crime as a Gendered Experience: Gender and Risk Perception in Public Spaces," which was originally written for the fall 2020 sociology research methods class.

Professor of Sociology **Reggie Byron** served on a "Teaching in the Liberal Arts" remote panel for the sociology department at the Ohio State University on July 28, 2021. He also presented a paper remotely at the Annual Meetings of the American Sociological Association on August 7, 2021. The paper, titled "'Get Rid of That Ghetto Element': Race, Gender, Work Sector, and Employers' Ideal Worker Pursuits" reflected key findings from chapter 2 of his forthcoming *Rose Series in Sociology* book on employment discrimination across the U.S.

April 2021

Are antibias diversity trainings effective? Associate Professor of Sociology **Reggie Byron** and others weigh in on the efficacy of these widely used trainings and some of their limitations in this recent Acorns–CNBC *Grown* news article.

Quantitative Sociological Study of Fear at the Southern Sociological Society on 7 April 8. The conference was held online.

Madeline Yu Carrola ('19) had a peer-reviewed article titled "Activists in Red Capes: Women's Use of *The Handmaid's Tale* to Fight for Reproductive Justice" published in *The Journal for Undergraduate Ethnography*. The article is based on her 2018 sociology capstone project.

February 2021

Professor of Sociology **Sandi Nenga** has been appointed to a three-year term on the editorial board of *Sociological Studies of Children and Youth* (UK: Emerald).

January 2021

to Commemorate the Black Lives and Deaths That Produced Its Sugar and Built Its Wealth,” can be found [here](#).

December 2020

Associate Professor of Sociology **Reggie Byron** was invited to offer feedback on an equal employment opportunity policy memo written by the leadership at the Center for Employment Equity after being solicited by incoming U.S. President Biden and his campaign. Byron’s name (and Southwestern’s) is listed in the acknowledgments along with those of seven other scholars from research universities who are noted for having a “deep knowledge of the enforcement process and EEOC [Equal Employment Opportunity Commission] data quality.”

November 2020

Associate Professor of Sociology **Reggie Byron** published a review of the book *Should Schools be Colorblind?* by Laurie Cooper Stoll in the sociology journal *Social Forces*. The review can be found [here](#).

Associate Professor of Sociology **Reggie Byron** published a peer-reviewed teaching exercise titled "Teaching Criminology during a Pandemic" in the American Sociological Association's *Teaching Resources and Innovations Library for Sociology (TRAILS)*. The resource can be found [here](#).

October 2020

Professor of Anthropology **Mel Johnson**, Associate Professor of Education **Alicia Moore**, and Professor of Philosophy **Phil Hopkins** were panelists for the Georgetown Public Library event "Confronting Racism: A Community Conversation." The event offered three sessions centered around three selected texts aimed at children, young adults, and adults. Moore participated in the panel discussing *New Kid* by Jerry Craft, a graphic novel about the struggle to fit in with a world that doesn't look like you. Hopkins participated in the panel discussing *The Hate U Give* by Angie Thomas, which details the impact of police violence on communities of color. Johnson participated in the panel on Ibram X. Kendi's *How to Be an Antiracist*, a best-selling book on how to fight racism and inequality.

August 2020

Megan Piel '20 participated in the American Sociological Association's 2020 Undergraduate Honors Program (held online) on August 8. She presented her paper "Religion, Gender, and Attitudes towards the LGBTQ+ Community," which was originally written for the Research Methods class in sociology.

April 2020

Associate Professor of Sociology **Reggie Byron** is reviewing more than 35 published articles (as the only invited reviewer from a liberal-arts university) for the prestigious Richard Scott Best Article Award through the Organizations, Occupations, and Work section of the American Sociological Association.

Associate Professor of Sociology **Reggie Byron** had a peer-reviewed article titled "Neighborhood Context, Race, and U.S. Newspaper Coverage of Home-Invasion Crime" accepted for publication in the *Journal of Criminal Justice and Popular Culture*.

Professor of Sociology **Maria Lowe**, Associate Professor of Sociology **Reggie Byron**, and student coauthors **Holly O'Hara** '17 and **Dakota Cortez** '19 had a peer-reviewed article titled "Neutralized Hegemonic Banter: The Persistence of Sexist and Racist Joking among Undergraduate Students" accepted for publication in *Sociological Inquiry*. This is the fourth such coauthored campus climate-related study that Lowe and Byron have published.

Feburary 2020

Part-Time Assistant Professor of Anthropology **Naomi Reed** was interviewed by CBS News to contribute to a Web and television segment on a Texas textbook's representations of slavery and Black people. The article reads in part, "CBS News is not the first to point out problems with *The American Pageant*. Dr. Naomi Reed is a sociocultural anthropologist and professor at Southwestern University in Texas. She looked at the 12th edition of the textbook in 2007 and the 15th edition in 2015, and said it consistently takes a white redemptive narrative of American history." You can read the article [here](#).

Sociology alumna **Samantha Pentecost** '19 has had her capstone paper, "Gendering the Boy Scouts: Examining Hegemonic Masculinity at a Coed Backpacking Camp," accepted for publication in the *Journal for Undergraduate Ethnography*(vol. 10, no. 2). In addition, sociology alumna **Madeline Carrola** '19 received the best undergraduate paper award for her capstone paper, "Performing *TheHandmaid's Tale*: The Use of Dystopian Literature at Political Protests," at the October 2019 Mid-South Sociological Association meeting. Both capstone papers were written under the direction of Professor of Sociology **Maria Lowe**.

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CONTACT